



MALLS AND MULTIPLEXES ARE EATING UP THE SYMBOLS OF THE RAJ.



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The Palace theatre; (left) the Rajshri Tandon Mandapam of the Hindi Sahitya Sammelan University

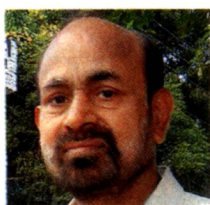
our university to a Central one, but it has hardly made any difference," say Lalsa Yadav and her husband Surya Narain Singh, who teach in the Hindi department of the university. "While more than 40 per cent posts of the teachers have been lying vacant, Rs 300 crore of the Union HRD Ministry funds sent to us remains unused. Also, enrolment in many faculties is waning every year. Where has this Oxford of the East gone?" they ask.

The judiciary's case is no better. "There are nearly eight lakh cases pending in the Allahabad High Court," says Girish Verma, retired registrar of the court. He also deplores the manner in which the gracious architecture of the city has been mangled into modern landscape of horror. "These bungalows and wide roads were once the identity of Allahabad," says Verma. Gaur too is concerned about the systematic dismemberment of Allahabad that had strong bonds with the Raj and its etiquette. She says it is unfortunate that the colonial bungalows are being demolished to make way for malls and multiplexes.

New age transition blues or a downward spiral that may pass the point of no return anytime soon, Allahabad needs to right itself yet again. For itself.

“A major portion of the MLAs fund is being eaten up by criminals. Why should I receive it?”

ANUGRAH N. SINGH,
Congress MLA, City North



In literature as well as law, the city is today a pale shadow of its glorious past. It was a landmark judgement of the Allahabad High Court that declared the election of Indira invalid, who then imposed the Emergency in 1975. In what could best describe the city's fading glory, for a long time none of the country's prestigious civilian awards has gone to an Allahabad resident, while adjoining Varanasi and Lucknow boast of a number of such awardees. The prestigious Allahabad University, which once earned the sobriquet of the Oxford of the East, has been reduced to an arena of politicking and incompetence. "The Government has elevated the status of